

His Name Shall be Called Wonderful (2) The Arm of the Lord

One of the lesser known of the divine titles of the Lord Jesus, is the title, *“The Arm of the Lord”*. The *“Arm of the Lord”* is referred to numerous times throughout the Old Testament Scriptures and signifies God’s might and power. It is frequently associated with God’s deliverance of Israel from the bondage of Egypt.

The *“Arm of the Lord”* is a powerful expression, reminding us of God’s sovereign authority and His ability to accomplish His divine will and purposes. It is also a testament to God’s faithfulness and commitment in providing for His purchased possession.

In the 51st chapter of the prophecy of Isaiah, *the Arm of the Lord* is called upon to awake for the deliverance of the people as in the ancient days. The prophet is reminded of how the arm of the Lord dried up the sea, the waters of the great deep; and made a way so that the people of Israel, the ransomed of the Lord could pass over (Isa. 51:9-10).

The arm of the Lord was manifested in glorious, delivering power at the Red Sea. On that occasion, Israel praised the Lord with a song of deliverance, celebrating the victory over their enemies, *“Fear and dread shall fall upon them; by the greatness of thine arm they shall be as still as a stone; till thy people pass over; O Lord, till the people pass over; which thou hast purchased”* (Ex. 15:16).

One of the more familiar passages containing the name, *“The Arm of the Lord”*, is found in Isaiah chapter 53. It is a powerfully moving chapter which prophetically portrays Jehovah’s faithful Servant and His sufferings for sin. The prophet asks, *“who hath believed our report? And to whom is the arm of the Lord revealed?”* (Isa. 53:1).

The question, *“who hath believed our report?”*, does not look for an answer, but is a sad reflection on the widespread unbelief of the nation of Israel. The *“report”* that the prophet refers to is the prophetic message from the Lord concerning the coming of Messiah, and particularly His suffering for sin.

As we noted, the expression, *“the Arm of the Lord”*, signifies, Jehovah’s might and power and His sovereign authority to accomplish His divine will and purposes. Here, in Isaiah chapter 53, it points to God’s great plan of redemption, accomplished through His suffering Servant, the Lord Jesus Christ.

This passage, part of the prophecy regarding the suffering Servant, suggests that the revelation of God’s power and salvation through the Messiah, the Lord Jesus Christ, may not be recognized by all. John wrote concerning Him, *“He was in the world, and the world was made by him, and the world knew him not. He came unto his own, and his own received him not”* (Jn. 1:10-11).

John referred to Isaiah’s prophecy, indicating that the Lord Jesus is the person referred to as the *“Arm of the Lord”*. He wrote, *“but though he had done so many miracles before them, yet they believed not on him: That the saying of Esaias the prophet might be fulfilled, which he spake, Lord, who hath believed our report? and to whom hath the arm of the Lord been revealed?”* (Jn. 12:37-38).

In the New Testament, the Lord Jesus is the ultimate expression of God’s power and salvation. Through His sinless life, sacrificial, atoning death, and ultimate glorious resurrection out from amongst the dead, the Lord Jesus demonstrated the might of God’s arm in overcoming sin and death, offering deliverance from sin and redemption to humanity.

Throughout the Old Testament Scriptures, we read of the arm of the Lord being stretched out. The prophet Jeremiah reminds us of the power of God's outstretched arm manifested in the creation of the world, "*I have made the earth, the man and the beast that are upon the ground, by my great power and by my outstretched arm, and have given it unto whom it seemed meet unto me*" (Jer. 27:5).

The Lord promised the people of Israel that He would demonstrate the power of His outstretched arm in delivering them from the bondage of Egypt, "*I am the Lord, and I will bring you out from under the burdens of the Egyptians, and I will rid you out of their bondage, and I will redeem you with a stretched out arm*" (Ex. 6:6).

Later, Moses reminded them of the fulfillment of God's promise of deliverance, "*And remember that thou wast a servant in the land of Egypt, and that the Lord thy God brought thee out thence through a mighty hand and by a stretched out arm*" (Deut. 5:15).

As we have noted, the expression, "*the Arm of the Lord*", is a divine title of the Lord Jesus Christ. He is the fulfillment of God's plan of redemption and reconciliation for all of mankind.

Just as God delivered Israel from the bondage of Egypt by the power of His stretched out arm, so too, He has accomplished the forgiveness of sin and reconciliation to Himself by the power of His stretched out arm.

It is written of the Lord Jesus, "*And when they were come to the place, which is called Calvary, there they crucified him*" (Luke 23:33). His prophetic words are recorded in the book of Psalms, "*they pierced my hands and my feet*" (Ps. 22:16). Peter wrote of Him, "*who his own self bare our sins in his own body on the tree*" (1st Pet. 2:24).

On the cross, the Lord Jesus, with out stretched arms, bore our sins and the wrath of God we so rightly deserve. While His arms were outstretched, He shed His precious blood, as the ransom price, providing cleansing and forgiveness of sins and reconciliation to God.

What a mighty deliverance was accomplished by the "*Arm of the Lord*"! The apostle Paul wrote concerning the Lord Jesus in his letter to the Colossians, "*Who hath delivered us from the power of darkness, and hath translated us into the kingdom of his dear Son*" (Col. 1:13). He reminds us in his letter to the saints at Thessalonica that the "*Arm of the Lord*", God's Son from heaven, has delivered us from the wrath to come.

*See in wonders of creation,
God's almighty arm made bare;
Nature's voice to every nation,
Doth His majesty declare.*

*O'er the enemy pursuing,
Arm of God outstretched in might;
Israel stands in triumph viewing,
All their foes are put to flight.*

*Arms outstretched in mercy pleading,
Rising early, day by day,
Erring people ever leading,
Bringing back into His way.*

*Born in lowly, humble manger
Arm of God has been displayed;
Yet He lives, the outcast stranger;
In the world His hands had made.*

*Arms outstretched in intercession,
Bound by nails to shameful tree;
Precious blood for sin's remission
From the Saviour, flowing free.*

Bernie Payne